
ACTOR PART BOOK

Player 3

the youngest in the company — Juvenile Lead, Prompter, and the small parts

Six Characters in Search of an Author

Sei personaggi in cerca d'autore · Pirandello, trans. Storer 1922

A Village Players production · Lausanne

Director: **Kiarash Jamshidi**

24 SPEECHES · 343 WORDS ACROSS THE PLAY

A NOTE ON CASTING

Player 3 may be played by a young man or a young woman — the part is written for either. This book uses *they*; once the role is cast, settle on the pronoun that fits the actor and adjust the handful of stage directions that carry it.

WHO PLAYER 3 IS

The youngest in the company, by a good ten years — early twenties, first proper season. They are the happiest person in the building; they still cannot quite believe they are being paid (a little) to spend their evenings inside a theatre. They do a bit of everything, and no job is beneath them, because all of it is theatre, and theatre is the thing they love.

Their dominant register is *curious*. Where Player 1 has opinions and Player 2 has shoulders, Player 3 has questions. **The notebook is their tell:** they write everything down — and the moment they stop writing is the moment the play has stopped being a curiosity and become something they would rather not have on record.

Their arc: Act One, enthralled by the strangers and a little embarrassed by it — the one Player who says out loud that the Father *means* every word. Act Two, they stop nodding; the pencil goes still. Act Three, they are the conscience who asks whether someone should stop this, and waits, and is not answered. Their face is the audience's mirror at every horror in the second half.

THE FUNCTIONS THEY CARRY

- **Juvenile Lead** — eager, slightly ridiculous; told they have "stage presence" and heard it as a promise.
- **Prompter** — in the wooden box, frowning at the draught and the shorthand, pleased to be useful, compensating for their youth with seriousness.
- **An Actor** and the **Fifth Actor** — they read the small parts clean, no pretension, and look to Player 2 to check they did it right.

HOW TO READ THIS BOOK

Everything Player 3 says and does, in performance order, grouped by act and by part. Each of their speeches is preceded by a short **CUE** — the tail of the line before theirs — so you can find your entrance. The function they are in (*as Prompter, as Juvenile Lead*) is printed beside each line. Their blocking lives in the bracketed action cues inside the speeches. The text is pulled byte-for-byte from the Director's Copy, so it always matches the current script.

Act One

PART I *The Rehearsal*

PLAYER 3 HERE · 3 SPEECHES · 77 WORDS · PROMPTER

CUE *Player 1 (as Leading Man):* ... public came back for the third act once. I was in it.

PLAYER 3 *(as Prompter) [reading the "book"]:* "Leo Gala's house. A curious room serving as dining-room and study."

CUE *Player 2 (as Property Man):* Red set. Same flats as the blue room. I'll turn them round.

PLAYER 3 *(as Prompter) [reading from the "book"]:* "When the curtain rises, Leo Gala, dressed in cook's cap and apron is busy beating an egg in a cup. Philip, also dressed as a cook, is beating another egg. Guido Venanzi is seated and listening."

CUE *Player 1 (as Leading Man):* Let the record show that I wear it under protest.

PLAYER 3 *(as Prompter):* Pardon, sir — may I get into my box? There's a draught off that door they still haven't mended, and I'd rather not be hoarse for my first proper season.

PART II *The Plea*

PLAYER 3 HERE · 11 SPEECHES · 179 WORDS · JUVENILE LEAD

CUE *The Step-Daughter:* ... us on tonight — we'll draw better than whatever you were rehearsing.

PLAYER 3 *[coming forward from the others]:* Oh — do you hear that?

CUE *The Father:* ... woman. So one may also be born a character in a play.

PLAYER 3 *[softly, to Player 2]:* Sorry — is this still the rehearsal?

CUE *Player 2 (as Leading Lady):* ... all down, and we'll work out later which half was the play.

PLAYER 3 *[doing exactly that, in a small notebook]:* I *am* writing it all down. I've got "born a character in a play." I don't know what it means yet — but it seemed like the sort of thing one is meant to keep.

CUE *The Father:* No, sir, only for a moment... in you.

PLAYER 3. Just listen to him. Honestly — just listen. I came in for a Tuesday rehearsal, and there is a man on our stage who means every word he says. When did anyone here last mean a word?

CUE *Player 1 (as Leading Man):* Speak for yourself. I have room.

PLAYER 3 *(as Juvenile Lead) [pointing to the STEP-DAUGHTER]:* I've no objection, as far as that one is concerned!

CUE *Player 2 (as Leading Lady):* We are the audience this time.

PLAYER 3 *[quietly, the pencil not moving]:* For once. *[Nobody laughs.]*

CUE *The Father*: ... and you hear another? We think we understand. We never really do.

PLAYER 3 [*a whisper to Player 1*]. I understood *words*. I'm fairly confident about *words*.

CUE *The Manager*: Of course, of course; but let's hear them out.

PLAYER 3 (*as Juvenile Lead*) [*the most earnest of the three, genuinely curious*]. This is something quite new. I have not seen anything quite like this before.

CUE *Player 3 (as Juvenile Lead)*: ... something quite new. I have not seen anything quite like this before.

PLAYER 3 [*dropping the role, lower, to Player 2 — nervous, fast*]. We did Pirandello at the school in Geneva. Two scenes, in a basement, badly. I keep thinking — this is what it was supposed to feel like, and nobody ever told us.

CUE *The Father*: ... is the way we tell each other: blind yourself, because I have.

PLAYER 3 [*low, to Player 1*]. Is anyone else following this? At all?

CUE *Player 1 (as Leading Man)*: ... I am nodding, and so should you. Nodding is half the craft.

PLAYER 3 [*nodding — then catching themselves nodding, and stopping*]. I'm following *some* of it. I'm just not sure I want to follow the rest. That's new for me as well.

PART III *The Bargain*

PLAYER 3 HERE · 3 SPEECHES · 15 WORDS · JUVENILE LEAD, PROMPTER

CUE *Player 1 (as Leading Man)*: ... six strangers into his office and left us standing here like furniture.

PLAYER 3 (*as Juvenile Lead*). They are not ordinary strangers.

CUE *Player 2*: He once staged the Nativity in fifteen.

PLAYER 3. Perhaps there is a play.

CUE *Player 1 (as Door-keeper)*: They looked expected.

PLAYER 3 (*as Prompter*). Am I taking this down?

Act Two

PART I *Backstage*

PLAYER 3 HERE · 3 SPEECHES · 27 WORDS · PROMPTER

CUE *The Son*: ... apart from that idea of father and mother which we give them?

PLAYER 3 [*very quietly, the pencil gone still in their hand*]. *Mon Dieu*. I've stopped writing it down. I don't want a record of this one.

CUE *The Manager*: ... I'm going to ask you to do something out of the ordinary.

PLAYER 3 (*as Prompter*) [*looking up from the book; an unusual request to receive at this hour*]. Take it down in shorthand? Sir — *in shorthand*?

CUE *The Manager*: Exactly! Can you do shorthand?

PLAYER 3 (*as Prompter*). Yes, a little.

PART II *The Apparition*

PLAYER 3 HERE · 2 SPEECHES · 18 WORDS · JUVENILE LEAD

CUE *Player 1 (as Leading Man)*: What's going to happen next? Have we lost the script entirely?

PLAYER 3 (*as Juvenile Lead*). Where does *she* come from? Not from the SSA list, I can tell you that.

CUE *Player 1 (as Leading Man)*: What does she say? Madame — speak up.

PLAYER 3 (*as Juvenile Lead*). Louder! Louder please!

PART III *The Substitution*

PLAYER 3 DOES NOT SPEAK IN THIS PART — THEY ARE ON THE FLOOR WITH THE COMPANY, WATCHING.

Act Three

PART I *The Argument over Reality*

PLAYER 3 DOES NOT SPEAK IN THIS PART — THEY ARE ON THE FLOOR WITH THE COMPANY, WATCHING.

PART II *The Refusal*

PLAYER 3 HERE · 1 SPEECH · 20 WORDS · AS HERSELF

CUE *The Father:* ... life. We've all tried him in turn — I, she and she.

PLAYER 3 *[to no one in particular — the youngest voice in the room].* Should we — should someone — stop this? I keep waiting for one of you to say that we should. *[No one does.]*

PART III *The Fountain*

PLAYER 3 HERE · 1 SPEECH · 7 WORDS · JUVENILE LEAD

CUE *The Son:* What do you want?

PLAYER 3 *(as Juvenile Lead).* Nothing! I was just looking at you.

Village Players · Lausanne · Player 3 part book · lines and actions pulled from the Director's Copy.